MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience and ownership of CI/CD pipelines and test infrastructure for three product teams. Builds and improves delivery workflows, Kubernetes-based merge-request environments and observability tooling, with measurable results in pipeline speed, CI runner costs and test reliability. Complements this hands-on team infrastructure work with personal k3s, GitOps, monitoring and Terraform-based VPS provisioning. Targeting DevOps and platform engineering roles.

SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environment deployments)
Infrastructure as code and cloud: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS provisioning), AWS (personal learning: EC2 and S3 basics), Ansible (basic)
Observability and systems: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Linux, PostgreSQL, TLS certificate management with cert-manager (personal homelab)
Automation and testing: Python, Bash, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Java (test code), SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software *2021-Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), including build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests; reduced monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.
- Built merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Python and Bash tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and built Grafana dashboards to track flaky tests using CI results.
- Wrote internal documentation explaining how CI works, which is used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House *2019-2021*

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018-2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024-2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)